Fishermen Issue

- According to Joint Working Group on Fisheries (JWGF) data, 111 boats of Tamil Nadu fishermen and 51 Indian fishermen were in arrest or detention in Sri Lanka's Northern Province in 2019.
- Reasons include on-going disagreement over the territorial rights to the island of Kachchatheevu, and the damaging economic and environmental effects of trawling.
- Due to the dearth of multi-day fishing capability, Indian fishermen cannot shift their fishing effort from the Palk Bay area to the offshore areas way beyond the continental shelf.
- Also, due to a gradual drop in fish count in the Indian waters, Indian fishermen are forced to wander into Sri Lankan waters as the catch is insufficient here.
- In November 2016, an inter-ministerial delegation discussed terms for a joint working group, but the Sri Lankan delegation rejected India's request for a three year grace period so that the government can assist fishermen to move from bottom trawling fishing method to another sustained and effective method.

Shastri – Srimavo Agreement, 1964



Mrs Srimavo Bandaranaike visited India in 1964. After prolonged negotiations, an agreement was signed between Bandaranaike and Shastri.

- It sought to solve the problem of 9 lakh 75 Thousand stateless persons in Sir Lanka using the following formula:
- 3 lakh people will get Sir Lankan citizenship.
- 5 lakh 25 thousand will get Indian citizenship. They were to move to India in a period spanning over 15 years.
- Remaining 1.50 lakh stateless persons fate was to be decided later.

Rajiv – Jayawardene Agreement (Indo-Sri Lanka Accord), 1987



Diplomatic agreement between PM Rajiv Gandhi and Srilanka President JR Jayawardane to solve the ethnic problem.

- An autonomous unit comprising northern and eastern provinces (where Tamils are concentrated) would be constituted.
- Elections to provincial councils were to be completed by Dec 31, 1987 in the presence of Indian observers.
- Emergency was to be lifted from northern and eastern provinces.
- Tamil, Sinhalese and English would be official languages of Sir Lanka.
- Deployment of IPKF to guarantee and enforce cessation of hostilities between Lankan army and Tamil militants.

Agreement was vehemently opposed by Sri Lankans and an attack was attempted on Rajiv Gandhi when he was inspecting guard of honour at Colombo airport.

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